

ODOO FOR BUSINESS

A Practical Course in ERP and Business Automation Using Odoo

A Hands On Program for Real Business Use

36 Hours. 6 Weeks. 6 Hours Per Week.

For Students, Working Professionals, and Business Owners

Platform Used: Odoo Online, Enterprise Edition

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1. Course Overview

1.1 What This Course Is About

This course teaches you how to run a business on Odoo. You will learn how a company can use one connected system to manage sales, purchasing, inventory, accounting, manufacturing, and human resources, instead of relying on separate spreadsheets and disconnected tools.

Each week of training maps to a real part of how a business operates, so what you learn in class is exactly what you will use on the job or in your own business.

This is a functional course. You will learn how to configure Odoo, design business processes, and automate routine work using Odoo Studio, which requires no programming. You will not be writing code. This course builds the skills of a confident Odoo user and business systems consultant, not a software developer.

1.2 Who This Course Is For

- Students who want a practical, job ready skill in ERP and business systems before they graduate.
- Working professionals in accounting, operations, supply chain, sales, or IT support who want to move into ERP implementation or business analysis roles.
- Business owners and SME managers who want to streamline daily operations, replace manual processes, and understand exactly what Odoo can automate for their company before investing in it.

1.3 Why Businesses Need This

Most small and growing businesses run on a mix of Excel sheets, WhatsApp messages, paper records, and separate software for accounting and inventory. This creates duplicate work, lost information, and decisions made on guesswork instead of real numbers.

An ERP system such as Odoo brings sales, purchasing, stock, accounting, and HR into one place. A sales order can automatically update stock, trigger an invoice, and feed into financial reports without anyone re-entering the same data twice. This course teaches you how that connection works and how to set it up correctly.

1.4 What You Need Before You Start

- Basic computer skills and comfort with spreadsheets such as Excel or Google Sheets.
- A general sense of how a business works is helpful, but not required. Week 1 starts from first principles.
- No prior Odoo, accounting, or programming experience is required. Basic accounting concepts are introduced in Week 3 for anyone without a finance background.

1.5 What You Will Be Able to Do by the End of This Course

1. Set up and configure a working Odoo system covering Sales, Purchase, Inventory, Accounting, HR, and Manufacturing.
2. Take a business requirement from a company or client and turn it into a working Odoo configuration.
3. Set up core accounting processes, including taxes, customer invoices, vendor bills, payments, and bank reconciliation.
4. Configure inventory operations such as warehouses, stock routes, and removal strategies, and connect them correctly to sales and purchasing.

5. Set up a basic manufacturing process and the core HR functions of employee records, time off, and payroll.
6. Use Odoo Studio to build custom fields, automated actions, approval workflows, and simple reports without writing a single line of code.
7. Explain clearly the difference between cloud hosting and an on premise installation, so you know which option fits a given business.
8. Gather requirements, test a configuration, prepare training material, and present a finished setup to a client or manager.

1.6 Tools and Platform Used in Class

Main platform	Odoo Online, with Enterprise apps enabled on a training account
Hosting note	Hands on practice uses Odoo Online. Other hosting options are explained in Week 6 for comparison, but are not used for live practice
Customization tool	Odoo Studio, a no code tool included in the Enterprise edition. It is not available in the free Community edition
Supporting tools	A web browser, Excel or Google Sheets for import files, and a shared workspace for saving screenshots and notes

2. Course Structure at a Glance

The course runs for 36 hours across 6 weeks, with 6 hours of training each week. Each week is split into two 3 hour sessions. The first session covers concepts and a live walkthrough. The second session is a guided hands on lab where you build the configuration yourself.

Week	Theme	Odoo Apps Covered	What You Will Achieve
1	Getting Started and the Sales Process	Essentials, CRM, Sales	Set up a company in Odoo and run a complete cycle from lead to quotation to confirmed sales order
2	Purchasing and Inventory	Purchase, Inventory, Barcode (overview)	Set up warehouses and stock routes, and run a complete cycle from purchase order to stock receipt to delivery
3	Accounting and Finance	Accounting and Invoicing	Set up the chart of accounts, taxes, invoices, bills, payments, bank reconciliation, and core financial reports
4	Manufacturing and Human Resources	Manufacturing, Employees, Payroll, Time Off, Recruitment (overview)	Set up a production process using a bill of materials, and configure core HR and payroll functions
5	Automation, Customization, and Reporting	Studio, Approvals, Automated Actions, Spreadsheet and Dashboards	Build custom fields, approval workflows, and management dashboards without writing code
6	Project Tools, Deployment Options, and Final Test	Project, Helpdesk, Subscriptions (overview), General Settings, hosting comparison	Complete a full business setup and sit a final practical test covering the whole course

Total training time is 36 hours. Each week closes with a short practical checkpoint described in Section 4.

3. Detailed Weekly Outline

WEEK 1 Getting Started and the Sales Process

6 Hours. Learn how Odoo is organized, set up your company, and run a complete sales cycle using Essentials, CRM, and Sales.

Learning Objectives

- Explain what Odoo is, how its apps connect to one another, and the difference between the Community and Enterprise editions.
- Explain the difference between cloud hosting and on premise hosting, and state clearly why this course is built around cloud hosting.
- Set up company details, create users, and assign basic access rights.
- Use the tools shared across every Odoo app: Contacts, Activities, Stages, Search, Filter, Group, and Export and Import.
- Run a complete CRM pipeline, from lead to opportunity to quotation, and confirm it as a sales order.

Session Plan

Session	Hours	Topic	Classroom activity and hands on practice
1A	3	Introduction to Odoo. Community versus Enterprise. Cloud hosting versus on premise hosting. How apps and modules connect. Company setup and multi company basics. Users and basic access rights.	Set up a training database. Create a company profile. Create two or three users with different access levels. Explore General Settings.
1B	3	Odoo Essentials: Contacts, Activities, Stages, Search, Filter, Group, Favorites, and Export and Import. The CRM app: pipeline stages, leads versus opportunities, and lost reasons. The Sales app: quotations, quotation templates, and pricelists.	Build a contact list using an import file. Create five CRM leads, convert two into opportunities, and mark one as lost with a reason. Create and send a quotation, then confirm it into a sales order.

End of Week Checkpoint

- Submit one fully confirmed sales order that came from your own CRM pipeline, with at least one pricelist or discount applied.

WEEK 2 Purchasing and Inventory

6 Hours. Learn how stock moves through a business, and connect Purchase and Inventory so that buying, receiving, and selling work together correctly.

Learning Objectives

- Set up products correctly, including product type and unit of measure, for both sales and purchasing.
- Run a complete purchase cycle: request for quotation, purchase order, and vendor bill, including the idea of three way matching.
- Set up warehouses, locations, and stock routes for one step, two step, and three step receiving and delivery.
- Apply removal strategies such as FIFO, LIFO, and FEFO, and explain when each one makes sense for a business.
- Read the Forecasted report, the Stock report, and understand basic inventory valuation.

Session Plan

Session	Hours	Topic	Classroom activity and hands on practice
2A	3	Product setup: type, unit of measure, and packaging. The Purchase app: requests for quotation, control policies, and vendor pricelists. How Purchase connects automatically to Inventory.	Configure five products covering storable, consumable, and service types. Create requests for quotation, confirm purchase orders, receive partial deliveries, and validate vendor bills.
2B	3	The Inventory app: warehouses and locations. Stock routes for one, two, and three step receiving and delivery. Putaway rules. Removal strategies: FIFO, LIFO, FEFO. Reordering rules. Reports for forecast, stock, and moves history.	Set up a two step delivery warehouse. Apply a FIFO removal strategy to a product category. Trigger a reordering rule. Fix a stock discrepancy using an inventory adjustment.

End of Week Checkpoint

- Document one complete cycle from purchase order to stock receipt to vendor bill, with a short note on which warehouse route and removal strategy you used and why.

WEEK 3 Accounting and Finance

6 Hours. Set up the financial backbone of the business: chart of accounts, taxes, invoices, bills, payments, and the reports a business owner actually reads.

Learning Objectives

- Understand core accounting ideas such as debit, credit, journals, and the chart of accounts, at the level a functional consultant needs.
- Set up the chart of accounts, journals, and taxes, and map fiscal positions for different customer and vendor situations.
- Process customer invoices and vendor bills from start to finish, including credit notes, payment terms, and bank reconciliation.
- Read and explain the Balance Sheet, Profit and Loss, and Tax Return reports in plain business terms.
- Understand what year end closing involves and why the Retained Earnings setup matters.

Session Plan

Session	Hours	Topic	Classroom activity and hands on practice
3A	3	Accounting basics and the double entry idea. Chart of Accounts. Journals. Taxes and tax computation. Fiscal positions. Customer invoices, payment terms, credit notes, and invoice numbering.	Set up a chart of accounts for a sample company. Create two tax rates and one fiscal position mapping. Issue three customer invoices, including one credit note.
3B	3	Vendor bills and the idea of document digitization. Payments, including online and batch payments. Bank and cash accounts, bank reconciliation, and reconciliation models. Reports: Tax Return, Balance Sheet, Profit and Loss, and the year end closing process.	Register a vendor bill and pay it. Import a sample bank statement and reconcile five transactions using a reconciliation model. Generate a basic Balance Sheet and Tax Return report.

End of Week Checkpoint

- Submit a short transaction trail covering one customer invoice and one vendor bill, fully reconciled against a bank statement, with one paragraph explaining which report you would show a business owner and why.

WEEK 4 Manufacturing and Human Resources

6 Hours. Set up a basic production process and the core HR functions every growing company needs: employee records, time off, and payroll.

Learning Objectives

- Build a bill of materials and run a one step or two step manufacturing order from start to finish.
- Explain work centers, manufacturing order costs, and basic production reports in plain terms.
- Set up core HR functions: employee records, departments, contracts, and time off types and allocations.
- Explain payroll basics, including salary structures, work entries, and payslips, and where country specific rules fit in.

Session Plan

Session	Hours	Topic	Classroom activity and hands on practice
4A	3	Manufacturing basics. Product setup for manufacturing. Bill of materials. One step and two step manufacturing. An introduction to work centers and manufacturing order costs.	Build a bill of materials with two components. Create and run a manufacturing order from confirmation to completion. Review the resulting stock moves and costs.
4B	3	Human Resources: employee records and departments. Time Off: types, allocations, and accrual basics. Payroll basics: contracts, salary structures, work entries, and payslips. A short look at how country specific rules apply.	Create an employee record with a contract. Set up one time off type and process a leave request from submission to approval. Generate a sample payslip and walk through what each line means.

End of Week Checkpoint

- Submit one completed manufacturing trail, from bill of materials to finished manufacturing order, and one completed HR trail, from employee record to contract to approved leave request to payslip explanation.

WEEK 5 Automation, Customization, and Reporting

6 Hours. Learn Odoo Studio, approval workflows, and automation rules. This is the most valuable skill in this course, because it lets you adjust Odoo to fit a business without writing code.

Learning Objectives

- Use Odoo Studio to add custom fields, change views, and create a simple custom model, all within what is allowed on a standard cloud account.
- Set up multi level approval rules on a real business document, such as a vendor bill or purchase order.
- Build automated actions that handle simple business rules automatically, without writing any code.
- Build a simple custom PDF report layout using the Studio report designer.
- Build a basic management dashboard using pivot tables, lists, and the Odoo Spreadsheet app.
- For each customization, explain clearly whether it works on a standard cloud account or whether it needs a different hosting setup or custom development.

Session Plan

Session	Hours	Topic	Classroom activity and hands on practice
5A	3	Odoo Studio: fields and widgets, views, and models. Custom PDF report design. What a standard cloud account allows and does not allow, explained with real examples.	Add three custom fields to an existing model using Studio: a text field, a selection field, and a computed field. Edit a list view and a form view. Customize the header of a quotation PDF report.
5B	3	Studio automation rules and approval rules. Spreadsheet and Dashboards: pivot tables, charts, and global filters.	Build a two level approval workflow on purchase orders above a set value. Create an automated action that posts a message when a field changes. Build a one page dashboard with two key numbers pulled from Sales and Inventory data.

End of Week Checkpoint

- Submit one working Studio package: a set of custom fields, one approval rule, one automated action, and one dashboard, with before and after screenshots and a short note on whether each piece works on a standard account or needs a different setup.

WEEK 6 Project Tools, Deployment Options, and Final Test

6 Hours. Get an overview of Project and Helpdesk, understand your hosting options clearly, and complete a full business setup before sitting the final test.

Learning Objectives

- Set up a basic Project workflow with tasks and milestones, and a basic Helpdesk pipeline with tickets and service level agreements.
- Explain clearly when a business should use cloud hosting, and when an on premise or self managed setup makes more sense.
- Run a structured conversation with a business owner or client to gather requirements, and turn that conversation into a clear configuration plan.
- Apply everything learned across the course to complete a full business setup and pass a final practical test.

Session Plan

Session	Hours	Topic	Classroom activity and hands on practice
6A	3	The Project app: tasks, stages, and milestones. The Helpdesk app: tickets and service level agreements. A deeper look at General Settings, Users, and Access rights. Cloud hosting versus on premise hosting, and Community versus Enterprise, explained side by side.	Set up a simple project with three stages and one milestone. Set up a Helpdesk team with one service level agreement. Complete a short worksheet comparing hosting options for three sample businesses.
6B	3	Final test. You receive a business scenario. You gather requirements, build the configuration across Sales, Purchase, Inventory, Accounting, and Studio as needed, and complete the setup under timed conditions.	Build the full scenario in your own training account. Prepare a one page summary of what you configured and why. Present a short walkthrough to the instructor, as if presenting to the business owner for sign off.

Note on Hosting Choices

- The right hosting choice for a business depends on cost, technical needs, and how much control the business wants over its own server. Always check current pricing and plan details before advising a business on this decision.

Final Test

- A timed, hands on test where you configure a complete business scenario from a written brief. This is the main assessment for course completion, described in Section 4.

4. Assessment and Certification

4.1 How Your Grade Is Calculated

Component	Weight	When
Weekly checkpoints, six in total	30%	End of each week
Mid course practical test covering Sales, Purchase, and Inventory	15%	End of Week 2 or start of Week 3
Studio and automation mini project	15%	End of Week 5
Final test	30%	Week 6
Class participation and lab engagement	10%	Throughout the course

4.2 About the Final Test

The final test takes place in Week 6, Session B. Each student receives a written business scenario covering a small company's sales, purchasing, inventory, and accounting needs. Working independently and under time conditions, the student configures Odoo to meet that scenario, then presents the finished setup to the instructor.

The test is graded on three things: whether the configuration is correct, whether the business process actually works end to end, and whether the student can explain their choices clearly.

4.3 What You Need to Pass and Get Certified

- At least 80 percent attendance across the six weeks.
- A passing score on the combined assessment, with a recommended minimum of 60 percent.
- A passing score on the final test in Week 6.

Suggested certificate title: Odoo for Business, Foundation Track. Keeping the title focused on what the course actually teaches helps avoid suggesting skills, such as advanced hosting setup or custom development, that this course does not teach hands on.

5. Course Design Notes and Boundaries

This section explains the thinking behind the course and is useful for instructors and for setting clear expectations with students, professionals, and business owners before the course begins.

5.1 What This Course Covers

- Every major business facing Odoo app: Essentials, CRM, Sales, Purchase, Inventory, Accounting and Invoicing, Manufacturing, Employees, Payroll, Time Off, Studio, and an overview of Project and Helpdesk.
- Odoo Studio as a full week of training, not a short add on topic. This is the single most useful skill for someone supporting a business on a standard cloud account, because it replaces work that would otherwise need a developer.
- A clear comparison of cloud hosting and on premise hosting throughout the course, so graduates never promise a business something the hosting plan cannot deliver.

5.2 What This Course Does Not Cover, and Why

- Writing code, building custom modules, or working with advanced technical settings. These skills belong to a developer or technical consultant track, not a functional course, and most of them are not available on a standard cloud account in any case.
- A detailed look at every country specific tax and compliance rule. Many countries are supported with their own tax settings. Week 3 teaches the general tax and fiscal position framework, and shows you how to look up a specific country's rules when a real project needs them.
- Full Point of Sale hardware setup, the Website and eCommerce builder, and Marketing Automation in depth. These are real Odoo apps, but 36 hours cannot cover every Odoo application at a hands on level. They are good candidates for a follow up advanced course.
- Full payroll rules for any one country. Week 4 teaches how the payroll engine works in general. The exact tax slabs and statutory rules for a specific country are a configuration detail you apply on a real project, not something a general course can teach once and for all.

5.3 A Natural Next Step: Advanced Course Ideas

- Point of Sale, covering hardware, restaurant and retail workflows, and payment terminals.
- Website and eCommerce, covering page building, checkout, delivery methods, and search engine optimization.
- Marketing tools, covering Email Marketing, Marketing Automation, Events, and Surveys.
- Advanced Accounting, covering multi currency consolidation, Intrastat reporting, and a deeper look at country specific tax rules.
- A technical track for anyone who wants to move toward a developer or technical consultant role.

5.4 Notes for Instructors Running This Course

- Give each student or pair of students their own Odoo Online training account, so every lab is genuinely hands on rather than a demonstration only.
- Reset the training account between groups of students, so configuration changes from one group do not carry over and confuse the next.
- Review the current Odoo interface before each new group starts, since menus and settings can shift slightly between releases.